



But an international cricketer aspires to be fit to perform – where they are physically and mentally ready, and skill-prepared for performance in an actual match scenario. The biggest risk of reinjury is rushing the rehab and not meeting the functional parameters of fitness, he says.

“There’s always pressure. That’s what the coaches ask first: ‘How long is this injury going to take?’ But we try to get an objective measure; that’s where the MRIs and X-rays give us an idea of what is happening at the tissue level. Then we look at the

context, the timeframe, whether there are any other psychological factors - the pressure on the player, is he in form or not.

“The ideal process of getting someone back is having no time pressure at all. Unfortunately, we live in a world where the guys are expected to play; that’s their job, and we are there to expedite that process. We understand the damage to the body or the perceived damage, then we look at the general return timeline for that type of injury, we look at the schedule and then work backwards from there whether

Risk management: Nitish Reddy’s injury underlines the other side of the equation, where workload, recovery and smarter management can help reduce the risks of a setback. GETTYIMAGES

the rehab to that kind of injury is going to be feasible or not. In an ideal world, we wish we had time and that we could meet the physiological milestone as the injury heals and we can build the load back up,” Leipus says.

Saini also emphasises the time factor in injury rehab. The